

TUCMUN I

Background Guide



Disarmament and International Security Committee (DISEC)

Rishi Akula and Sravanya Karunanidhi

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TUCMUN I

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Dear Delegates and Sponsors,

Welcome to the first iteration of TUCMUN, specifically, to the Disarmament and International Security Committee (DISEC). This committee handles issues such as threats to international security, ensuring peace internationally, and handling wars. As delegates of this committee, we will explore major events that disrupt the qiekxi community. These critical issues need to be addressed immediately and require diplomatic cooperation. Specifically, the Weapon Misusage in the Sudan Civil War and the occurrence of Narcoterrorism in Nigeria.

We are honored to be co-chairs for TUCMUN I for the DISEC committee. My name is Rishi Akula, and I am a freshman at John Randolph Tucker High School and am currently in the International Baccalaureate program. I have attended multiple conferences and won several awards in Model UN since pursuing this activity in the 6th grade. My name is Sravanya Karunanidhi, and I am thrilled to be your co-chair for DISEC. As a sophomore in the International Baccalaureate Program in John Randolph Tucker High School, I have explored different perspectives on international affairs and gained experience in public speaking through my time in Model United Nations. We look forward to seeing the innovative resolutions that you will bring to the table.

Delegates can succeed in this committee through thinking critically, preparing ahead, and conducting extensive research in advance. We look forward to engaging in the discussions you will bring forth!

Your chairs,

Sravanya Karunanidhi

Rishi Akula

Committee Overview

Established in 1945, the Disarmament and International Security Committee (DISEC) is the First Committee of the United Nations General Assembly and plays a central role in addressing pressing global issues related to international peace and security. As a key body within the UN system, DISEC focuses on disarmament, global arms control, conflict resolution, and the regulation of conventional and unconventional weapons. The committee addresses a broad scope of challenges—from nuclear non-proliferation and the control of small arms and light weapons, to preventing the militarization of outer space and combating illicit arms trafficking.

DISEC works in close coordination with the United Nations Security Council (UNSC), the United Nations Office for Disarmament Affairs (UNODA), and other global entities to propose non-binding resolutions and facilitate international dialogue aimed at promoting lasting peace

Topic I: Weapon Misuse in the Sudan Conflict

Background Information

The Sudanese Civil War is the first topic, and we focus on the misuse of weapons in this civil war. Due to a growing conflict, widespread displacement, an economic catastrophe, and a near-collapse of health care facilities, Sudan is on the list of the excruciating wars this year. The attempt of the military regime to impose Sharia law as part of its larger plan to "Islamize" all of Sudan in 1983 set off a civil war. The

and reducing threats to civilian populations. The committee also evaluates the impacts of modern warfare technologies such as cyber weapons, drones, and autonomous military systems, seeking to create frameworks for responsible and ethical use.

Over the years, DISEC has supported landmark international treaties such as the Treaty on the Non-Proliferation of Nuclear Weapons (NPT) and the Arms Trade Treaty (ATT), both of which aim to limit the spread of deadly weapons and reduce the risk of armed conflict. As global tensions rise and new security challenges emerge, DISEC remains a critical platform for multilateral diplomacy and cooperative problem-solving.

In this committee, delegates will tackle complex topics involving regional conflicts, disarmament strategies, and international arms regulation. Delegates are expected to bring forward innovative solutions, negotiate diplomatically, and collaborate on comprehensive resolutions that promote peace, security, and humanitarian protection on a global scale.

southern region, which was inhabited by Christians and Animists, saw uprisings led by the Sudan People's Liberation Army (SPLA) starting in 1983. In a new report, Amnesty International stated that the ongoing supply of weapons into Sudan is contributing to the war there by encouraging violence. Amnesty International obtained details regarding more than 1,900 shipments of weapons from Russia, the UAE, Serbia, and more into Sudan by reviewing shipments.

As we can see based on the statistics above, this topic needs to be addressed immediately. The misuse of weapons is a

prominent reason why this war has millions of casualties. The two main opposition groups of this conflict include the RSF (Rapid Support Forces) and the SAF (Sudanese Armed Forces). The reason why these groups were fighting was that the leader of the RSF, Mohammed Hamdan Dagalo, and the leader of the SAF, General Abdel Fattah al-Burhan, wanted control over Sudan. After overthrowing the previous leader, Omar al-Bashir, due to the SAF and RSF conjoined forces, it led to further conflict between these groups. After having a “military coup” as a way to remove the civilian government, these groups came into conflict over who should be in charge, Burhan and Dagalo. Also, the SAF wanted the RSF to be quickly integrated into the army, but the RSF wanted to delay the process. All these disagreements caused each group to seek international alliances, further increasing the severity of the Sudan weapon misuse, leading to an estimated 1000s dying. Both groups wanted to take control of the Khartoum government, the capital of Sudan; whoever took control of Khartoum was the leader. Burhan from the SAF is the de facto ruler, however, his authority has been challenged by the RSF. Many airstrikes and heavy shelling have been used to stop the RSF from invading Khartoum, as Dagalo has tried to attack to overthrow the SAF. The neighbors of the country Sudan armed opposition groups attempting to overthrow the Khartoum government, the flow of arms is also becoming more complicated, with Sudan serving as a hub for transshipment to warring parties as far away as the Middle East and Eastern Europe, as well as for the

distribution of weapons to armed groups operating in neighboring countries and beyond. Because Sudan is so active when it comes to weapons, it also poses a great threat to surrounding nations. The reason is that it increases illicit arms trafficking in countries such as Libya, Chad, and all around the Sahel Region, and more.

Solutions In Place

On a larger scale, multiple actions were implemented by various officials and the United Nations to stop weapon misuse. One of the biggest treaties made and passed was the Arms Trade Treaty of December 24th, 2014. This treaty states, “Any state that is a party to the treaty must obey strict rules on international arms transfers. These rules include setting up a national control system to oversee the conventional arms imported and exported through international trade. Also, countries have to take into account all arms sales, and risk assessments need to be conducted. This treaty has 113 state parties as signatories and 28 states that signed the treaty but did not ratify it. Also, the Treaty was designed to stop deadly weapons from getting into the hands of people who will use them to commit human rights violations, including genocide, crimes against humanity, and war crimes.

In the country of Sudan, efforts, both international and internal, have been made in an attempt to control the misuse of weapons. China, Russia, Serbia, and the UAE are examples of countries that have sent weapons to Sudan. The United Nations has played a crucial role for around two decades by supervising all weapon imports to Darfur, a South Sudanese city. Despite

this being only one place, it has successfully restricted any large increase of weaponry in the conflict zones of Sudan. This has proven to be safer in the past years, but many officials from Sudan strongly oppose the idea of expanding the embargo. Also, the UN Disarmament Commission was created to control measures such as discussing solutions for peace and supporting the resolution of conflicts.

The IGAD (Intergovernmental Authority on Development) has offered conciliatory measures, such as expressing urgency for countries to stop sending weapons to Sudan. They strongly urge countries like Iran and the UAE to stop supplying weapons and also take precautionary actions to truly stop them. Many diplomatic strategies such as this have also been implemented in Sudan, aiming to bring this crisis to an end. The IGAD has sent documents such as the IGAD Communiqué on Sudan Conflict to cause the cessation of hostilities and grant humanitarian assistance, and help create a peaceful resolution. Also, they have formed a Peace and Security Council Resolution to address these issues further.

Governmental actions aside, Sudanese civilians and non-governmental organizations have taken it upon themselves to work towards peace. Around 25 million people need humanitarian help. Sudan's economy is in a dire condition. The rate of inflation in Sudan is 350% as of 2023. Also,

Topic II: Narcoterrorism in Nigeria

Background Information

it has lost 75% of its oil revenue after South Sudan's secession, and 65% of the population is in poverty. The abundance of weapons inundation results in the egregious state of the country itself.

Other countries have also been getting involved to de-escalate the conflict by some measure. For example, Saudi Arabia has led many peace talks to improve the weapon misuse crisis in Sudan. Some ideas that came up include ceasefires and ideas that preserve humanitarian beliefs. These plans aim to reduce civilian casualties and also improve conditions in both Sudan and the surrounding countries that are being affected.

Questions to Consider

- What are some sanctions that are in action now, and how is it possible to improve the quality?
- How does this ongoing conflict affect the neighboring countries of Sudan in any way?
- How can the RSF and SAF create a solution that is acceptable to the international community?
- What are some efforts being made locally to protect the citizens, and are they effective?
- What are some diplomatic strategies that could be implemented to prevent any opportunity for a similar problem to arise in the future?

For the second topic in our committee, we will be focusing on the critical effects of narcoterrorism in the country of Nigeria. Narcoterrorism is essentially terrorism involved with drug

trafficking. Nigeria is the center for terrorist activities, drug trafficking, and other compelling issues. These issues not only undermine Nigeria but also weaken neighboring countries. It increases the amount of terrorism, affects global drug markets, neighboring countries such as Chad, Nigeria, and Cameroon have suffered terrorist attacks due to narcoterrorism, and increases the number of refugees. Nigeria has evolved to distributing, producing, and allowing the consumption of illegal substances. All the regions in Nigeria cultivate cannabis for domestic and international uses. More potent drugs such as heroin or methamphetamine have also become more prevalent. The two main groups in this conflict are Boko Haram and ISWAP (Islamic State West Africa Province), who have been responsible for narcoterrorism.

The activities of groups elucidate that terrorism and drug trafficking are interconnected in Nigeria. Engaging in drug trafficking enables such gangs to fund their operations, whatever they may be. In other words, narcoterrorism is nothing but a stable source of cash income for criminal syndicates. The money that is obtained helps them retain their powerful hold over the citizens and government of Nigeria.

The surge of illicit drug trading has also strengthened terrorist groups while making their networks stronger than ever. These drug networks are said to be operating both in and out of Nigeria, playing an indispensable role in the production and distribution of narcotics. Along with unlawful substances, prescription drugs are also being trafficked through Nigeria's weak

border security and corrupt law enforcement systems. According to some evidence that was found, it is also believed that insurgent gangs make use of these substances to improve the endurance and performance of their fighters.

This issue has also had a substantial impact on the socio-economic status of Nigeria. The increased use of drugs has also increased addiction and drug-related crimes. People from the northern part of Nigeria, a place more prone to conflicts, have frequently begun turning to drug trafficking to survive. This trap that lures destitute people has destabilized the country so much that millions of people are forcibly displaced from their homes. But this only triggers the terrorist groups to expand their operations, affecting nearby countries such as Chad, Niger, and Cameroon. Approximately 127,161 refugees from Nigeria are in place due to the conflict in Nigeria, causing concern worldwide.

Solutions in Place

To combat this humanitarian crisis, the Nigerian government has implemented several initiatives. For example, the National Drug Law Enforcement Agency (NDLEA) has made its eradication measures more rigorous. Some measures they have taken include destroying large cannabis farms, seizing cocaine shipments, and arresting the individuals in charge of the Narcoterrorism occurring. Since then, there has been an increase in narcotic seizures and arrests of key dealers. Also, internal measures have been in place, such as the Multinational Joint Task Force involving neighboring countries to protect themselves from the

dangerous threats of Narcoterrorism. Meticulous planning and enforcement are required for these rules to be correctly enforced. Therefore, changes in the law, such as harsher penalties, have been debated amongst lawmakers and should be in place in hopes of causing a change in Nigeria.

Global organizations like the United Nations Office on Drugs and Crime have helped offer support to the Nigerian government by enforcing rules. In airports, the UNODC works with the government to track drugs and make sure that drugs are not being imported. Technical support, like the improvement of Nigeria's chemical and forensic analysis, was extended. Furthermore, Nigeria has also reached out to improve regional partnerships with ECOWAS (Economic Community of West African States) by coordinating military opposition against Boko Haram and ISWAp with other countries.

Regardless of the many ongoing efforts, overcoming narcoterrorism remains a formidable fight for Nigeria. This problem can only completely subside if the country's socio-economy, international collaborations, and enforcement are all improved. Additionally, the solution must find a way to constrain the widespread networks of power of this issue.

Questions to Consider

1. What are some local initiatives, and how do they prevent the involvement of the youth in narcoterrorism?
2. What could be done to combat the networks created by the Nigerian cartel?
3. What have international organizations done so far, and how can their work be altered to be more effective?
4. How have government policies impacted the Narcoterrorism present in Nigeria? Could other measures be taken?
5. Does the cultivation/manufacturing of narcotics cause any public or environmental health consequences?

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